

Never paste real passwords, `secrets.live.php` contents, or DB credentials into AI chat, support tickets, or screenshots. After you change passwords, only type them in the hosting panel and on the server file editor.

A. WHAT THIS IS ABOUT

1. **Leaked credentials** — Anyone who saw them could try your database until you **change the MySQL user password**.
2. **Two places must match** — The password set in **hosting (MySQL)** and the value in `config/secrets.live.php` on the **live server** (field like `db.pass`). If they differ, the website shows a database error.
3. **Git** — Real secrets belong **only on the server**. The repo ships `config/secrets.live.php.example` with placeholders. Your project `.gitignore` should list `secrets.live.php` so it is not committed (do not force-add it).

B. CHANGE THE MYSQL USER PASSWORD (HOSTING CONTROL PANEL)

Many South African hosts (e.g. domains.co.za) use **cPanel**. Menu names can vary slightly.

1. Log in to your **hosting control panel** (cPanel) for the account where the live Autowagen site runs.
2. Open **MySQL® Databases** (or **Databases** → MySQL).
3. Find the **MySQL user** your live app uses (same as `db.user` in `secrets.live.php` on the server — often looks like `accountname_dbuser`).
4. Use **Change password** (or equivalent) for that user only.
5. Set a **new strong password**. Copy it **only** into a temporary safe place you control (password manager), or re-type it in the next step — **not** into chat or email.
6. Confirm that user still has **ALL PRIVILEGES** on your app database (if the panel shows user–database assignment). If the site worked before, this is usually already correct.

C. UPDATE SECRETS.LIVE.PHP ON THE LIVE SERVER ONLY

1. Connect with **cPanel File Manager** or **SFTP** (e.g. FileZilla) to the folder where Autowagen is installed.
2. Open `config/secrets.live.php`.
3. If it does not exist: copy `config/secrets.live.php.example` to `secrets.live.php` on the server, then fill real values.
4. Edit the return array:
 - `'host'` — usually `localhost` on shared hosting (use host documentation if different).
 - `'name'` — database name (often unchanged).
 - `'user'` — MySQL username (often unchanged).
 - `'pass'` — the **new** password from step B.
5. **Save** the file on the server.
6. Do **not** upload this file to GitHub with real values. Do not attach it to tickets.

D. TEST THE LIVE SITE

1. Open your live login page in the browser.
2. Sign in. If you see a **database connection** error, re-check: spelling of `db.user`, `db.name`, and `db.pass`, and that the MySQL user still has access to the database.

E. IF REAL SECRETS EVER WENT INTO GIT / GITHUB

1. Changing the live DB password stops new abuse of the **old** password, but **Git history** can still contain the old secret if it was committed.
2. If that happened, follow GitHub's official steps: [Removing sensitive data from a repository](#) (rewrite history / purge). Also **rotate** any password that was ever committed.
3. Going forward: keep `secrets.live.php` only on the server; repo keeps `secrets.live.php.example` .

F. HABITS

- Local PC (Laragon): use `config/secrets.local.php` — also gitignored.
- Never share live secrets in screenshots, Zoom screen-shares with unreadable blur only if you must, or AI chats.

Related: [docs/database_update_backup_guide_print.html](#) (SQL migrations) · [docs/client_install_print.html](#) (new PC) · Index: [docs/client_training_index.html](#)